ADDOVEDI

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ADDOVEDI 2026

HACKATHON

OFFICIAL RULEBOOK



EVENT START	FORMAT	HACKATHON EVENT HEAD
To be announced	24-Hour Continuous	Divyanshu Gupta

Organised by Coding Pundit

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

Date: To be announced | Venue: To be announced

Idea Pitch → Prototype Development → Final Demonstration

01 Event at a Glance

ITEM	DETAILS
Event	ADDOVEDI 2026 – Hackathon
Organised by	Coding Pundit, Department of Computer Science and Engineering
Hackathon Event Head	Divyanshu Gupta
Date	To be announced
Event start time	To be announced
Venue	To be announced
Format	Continuous 24-hour hackathon with three stages: Idea Pitch, Prototype Development and Final Demonstration
Team size	Minimum 2, maximum 4 members per team · Top 25 teams, first come, first served

Items marked **To be announced** are not yet confirmed. The organisers will announce them before the event.

02 Welcome and Overview

Welcome to the ADDOVEDI 2026 Hackathon, organised by Coding Pundit. The Hackathon is a three-stage Software Development and Innovation Competition. It tests your creativity, problem-solving ability, technical knowledge, teamwork and execution skills, and your ability to build a practical solution in limited time.

The competition moves from idea validation, to prototype development, and finally to a complete solution presentation. The evaluation becomes more rigorous at every stage, so winning teams must show excellence in both innovation and software engineering.

Build a solution, not just a project. Focus on a clear problem–solution fit, a working MVP, thoughtful engineering, and the ability to explain and defend your work.

03 Competition Format and Flow



* Round 1 is held only if more than 20 teams register.

- **More than 20 registered teams:** Round 1 (Innovation and Idea Pitch) is conducted as an elimination round. The top 15 teams qualify for Prototype Development.
- **20 or fewer registered teams:** The competition begins directly with Round 2 (Prototype Development), followed by the final presentation round.

- **Progress evaluation and screening** follow the development period. The best-performing teams are announced as finalists and go on to Round 3, the Final Demonstration and Presentation.

04 Event Schedule

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS
To be announced	Event start	The Hackathon begins.
To be announced	Round 1: Idea Pitch	Held only if more than 20 teams register. Top 15 teams qualify.
To be announced	Round 2: Prototype Development	Continuous development period. Judges and mentors may conduct periodic progress evaluations.
To be announced	Repository freeze	Your GitHub repository as it stands at the freeze time is your final version.
To be announced	Progress evaluation and screening	Teams present; the best-performing teams are announced as finalists.
To be announced	Round 3: Final Demonstration	Finalist demos, presentations and Q&A.
To be announced	Results and closing	Winners are announced.

The organisers will announce the exact clock times for every phase. Please check official announcements regularly.

05 Teams and Eligibility

- Each team must have **minimum 2 and maximum 4 members**.
- Only the **top 25 teams** can participate, selected on a **first-come, first-served** basis by registration time.
- Each participant may join **only one team**.
- Team details must be final at verification. The verification time will be announced by the organisers.
- Arrive on time. Late arrivals may lose build time.
- Follow all instructions from organisers, volunteers and judges.
- Any attempt to gain an unfair advantage may lead to investigation or disqualification.

Who can participate and how to register: To be announced. The registration fee is given at the end of this rulebook.

06 Problem Statement and MVP

- Your solution must directly solve the problem statement released by the organisers. A focused, working MVP beats a large, half-finished one.
- Extra features earn credit only when they genuinely improve the solution **and** actually work.
- Feature count alone does not decide the score.

07 Development, AI Tools and Third-Party Resources

- **Technology**
- Any language, framework, database, API or methodology is allowed.

- Deployment is optional. Localhost demos are fully acceptable. A live deployment can help during verification because judges can test it directly, but it adds no marks by itself.

AI tools

All AI tools are allowed: coding assistants, generative AI, design and research tools, APIs and any AI-enabled software. However:

- Using AI earns **no extra marks**. Judges score the final product, not how much AI you used.
- Your team is responsible for every line you submit.
- You must be able to explain the important parts of your code in Q&A.
- Never use any tool to fake functionality, falsify evidence or manipulate judging.

Libraries and services

Open-source libraries, frameworks, APIs, SDKs and cloud services are allowed under their licences and terms. Credit significant external resources in your README.

08 GitHub Repository and Submission

Every team must keep a **public GitHub repository** from the start of the Hackathon until the results are announced. Judges may review the repository and its full commit history.

> REPOSITORY FREEZE
>
> The repository as it stands at the freeze time is your final version. Changes after the freeze may be ignored. The freeze time will be announced by the organisers and is strict ("sharp").

Commit history and documentation

- Commit regularly with clear messages so judges can follow your progress.
- Maintain proper documentation and version control for your work.
- Repositories created or filled with code just before the event may be investigated.
- Commit count alone earns nothing. Genuine, authentic progress is what counts.

What to submit

1. Public GitHub repository URL
2. Project name and team details
3. Short project description
4. Major implemented features
5. Tech stack
6. Deployment URL (if any)
7. Steps to run or demo the project
8. Anything else the organisers request

09 Rounds in Detail

Round 1: Innovation and Idea Pitch (only if more than 20 teams register)

Each team gets a few minutes to present its project idea before the judging panel. Teams must:

- Identify and clearly define a real-world problem.
- Present an innovative and feasible solution.
- Explain the proposed technology stack and implementation approach.

- Demonstrate the expected impact, usability and scalability of the solution.
- Answer the judges' questions about the idea and technical approach.

This round mainly tests innovation, problem identification, technical feasibility, communication skills and overall project vision. The top 15 teams qualify for the development phase.

Round 2: Prototype Development

Qualified teams work throughout the Hackathon to turn their idea into a functional software prototype. During this phase, participants will:

- Design and develop their application or solution.
- Implement the core features of the project.
- Collaborate effectively within the team.
- Show consistent progress throughout the development period.
- Maintain proper documentation and version control.

Judges and mentors may conduct periodic evaluations to assess development progress and give guidance where required. This round mainly tests technical implementation, teamwork, problem-solving, software development skills, execution capability and project progress.

Progress evaluation and screening

After the development sprint, every team presents in a screening round. The best-performing teams become finalists, and the **top 8 teams** advance to the final round.

- **Time per team:** 5-minute presentation + 3-minute demo and Q&A.
- **Screening considers:** problem–solution fit, a working MVP, UI/product quality, and repository quality, architecture and implementation.
- Findings may be supported by automated repository checks and structured codebase analysis.

Round 3: Final Demonstration and Presentation

Finalist teams present their completed solution before the judging panel. Finalists demo the **actual submitted product**. Each team must:

- Demonstrate the working prototype.
- Explain the problem statement and the proposed solution.
- Present the system architecture, technologies used and implementation details.
- Highlight the uniqueness, scalability and future scope of the project.
- Answer technical and conceptual questions from the judges.

Faculty members conduct the final-round Q&A. They may ask about architecture, database design, APIs, security, technology choices, limitations and future improvements. **Time per team:** 5-minute presentation + Q&A with faculty. Time limits are strict, and every team member should be ready to answer.

This round evaluates the overall quality of the solution: innovation, technical implementation, functionality, user experience, presentation skills and the ability to justify design decisions.

10 Judging Criteria (100 Points)

Four equally weighted categories, 25 points each.

25 POINTS Problem and Solution

25 POINTS UI/UX and Product

25 POINTS Technical Implementation

25 POINTS Presentation and Q&A

CATEGORY	CRITERIA (POINTS)	TOTAL
Problem and Solution	Understanding of the problem (5) · Relevance (5) · Creativity and uniqueness (5) · Feasibility (5) · Effectiveness (5)	25
UI/UX and Product	User experience (5) · Interface and usability (5) · User flow (5) · Feature implementation and accessibility (5) · Overall product quality (5)	25
Technical Implementation	Architecture and design (5) · Code quality and maintainability (5) · Functionality and completeness (5) · Security and reliability (5) · Engineering practices (5)	25
Presentation and Q&A	Problem explanation (5) · Solution explanation (5) · Product demo (10) · Q&A and technical understanding (5)	25
Total		100

What judges look for in Technical Implementation

- **Architecture and design:** clean project structure, separation of concerns, sensible frontend/backend/API and database design, and technology choices that fit the problem.
- **Code quality:** readable code, meaningful names, consistent style, little duplication and proper error handling.
- **Functionality:** core features must really work. A button, placeholder route or README claim is not proof. Mocked or disconnected features count as incomplete.
- **Security and reliability:** authentication where needed, input validation, no exposed secrets or API keys, and graceful failure handling.
- **Engineering practices:** a clear README and setup steps, managed dependencies and config, testing/linting where sensible, and a meaningful commit history.

IMPORTANT

More code, files, frameworks, dependencies or features do not mean more marks. Unnecessary complexity, redundant features or tech used only for show will not be rewarded. Build what the problem actually needs, and build it well.

Evaluation across the stages

Teams are evaluated on innovation, technical complexity, implementation quality, functionality, teamwork, presentation, scalability and practical impact. The focus moves from idea quality in Round 1, to technical execution in Round 2, and to the completeness, usability and real-world applicability of the solution in Round 3.

Fair judging

- Judges score only against the published criteria.
- Judges step aside from evaluating any team where they have a significant conflict of interest.

Tie-breaks

If teams have equal total scores, ties are decided in this order:

1. Problem and Solution score
2. Technical Implementation score
3. UI/UX and Product score
4. Presentation and Q&A score
5. The judging panel's final decision based on the submitted work

11 Integrity, Conduct and Disqualification

Plagiarism and collusion are not allowed

- Copying another team's work or submitting someone else's project as your own.
- Sharing substantial code with competing teams during the event.
- Faking Git history, functionality, test results or project claims.

Security and responsible conduct

- Do not attack, disrupt or access another team's app, data, credentials or infrastructure.
- Do not attack or disrupt organiser or judging systems.
- Report any vulnerability you find in another project to the organisers. Do not exploit it.
- Do not include malicious code aimed at the evaluation environment.

Disqualification

Disqualification may result from plagiarism, cheating, misrepresentation, unauthorised access, malicious activity, manipulating judging, serious rule violations, or submitting after the deadline without permission.

12 Organiser Authority and Final Decisions

Organisers may clarify or adjust operational rules for technical or scheduling reasons, verify submissions, investigate violations and correct calculation errors. Material changes will be announced to all participants. **The organisers' decision is final.**

13 Quick Checklist for Teams

- Arrive on time with your full team.
- Create a public GitHub repo at the start of the Hackathon and commit regularly.
- Keep API keys and secrets out of the repo.
- Make sure core features actually work end to end.
- Write a clear README with setup and run steps.
- Push your final code before the repository freeze.
- Submit all required details.
- Prepare a 5-minute presentation and a quick demo. Every team member should be ready to explain the code.

14 Contact

ROLE	DETAILS
Hackathon Event Head	Divyanshu Gupta: 9695431255
President, Coding Pundit	Vinay Pal: 8840337686
Society	Coding Pundit, Department of Computer Science and Engineering

15 Details to Be Announced

The following details are not yet confirmed. The organisers will announce them before the event.

DETAIL	STATUS
Date, venue and clock times for each phase, including registration, team verification, repository freeze, screening, finals and closing	To be announced
Eligibility and registration process	To be announced
How the problem statement or theme is released	To be announced
Time allotted per team for the Round 1 idea pitch	To be announced
Judging panel members	To be announced

16 Join the Arena

SCAN TO JOIN

Addovedi Hackathon 2k26

WhatsApp group

Scan this QR code using the WhatsApp camera to join this group for official updates and announcements.

17 Registration Fee and Prize Pool

Registration Fee: ₹50 per member

Prize Pool: ₹30k+ (including Goodies)